

Response to the Draft Layover Policy

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

The draft states:

Operators shall not be required to accept a layover position that cannot accommodate a full-length vehicle without reversing.

Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles. ¹

Second observation

Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

Where a reversing manoeuvre is unavoidable, a banksman shall be provided for every movement, without exception.

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison. ²

The full consultation text is published at example.org/consultations/layover-policy and responses may be sent to consultation@example.org.

¹ Costed at the framework rate current at the date of this response; no allowance is made for indexation.

² The operator's own standard already requires this on all sites, so no additional cost is anticipated.